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Temple altar

4.2.3 Temple altar

References:

Aramaic מַדְבַּח (madbach) EZR 7:17

Hebrew מִזְבֵּחַ (mizbeach) 1KI 8:22, 1KI 8:31, 1KI 8:54, 1KI 8:64, 1KI 9:25, 2KI 11:11, 2KI 12:10, 2KI 16:11, 2KI 16:12, 2KI 16:12, 2KI 16:13, 2KI 16:14, 2KI 16:14, 2KI 16:14, 2KI 16:15, 2KI 16:15, 2KI 18:22, 2KI 21:4, 2KI 21:5, 2KI 23:9, 1CH 6:34, 1CH 16:40, 1CH 22:1, 2CH 4:1, 2CH 5:12, 2CH 6:12, 2CH 6:22, 2CH 7:7, 2CH 7:9, 2CH 8:12, 2CH 15:8, 2CH 23:10, 2CH 29:18, 2CH 29:19, 2CH 29:21, 2CH 29:22, 2CH 29:22, 2CH 29:22, 2CH 29:24, 2CH 29:27, 2CH 32:12, 2CH 33:4, 2CH 33:5, 2CH 33:16, 2CH 35:16, EZR 3:2, EZR 3:3, NEH 10:35, PSA 26:6, PSA 43:4, PSA 51:21, PSA 84:4, PSA 118:27, ISA 6:6, ISA 36:7, ISA 56:7, ISA 60:7, LAM 2:7, EZK 8:5, EZK 8:16, EZK 9:2, EZK 40:46, EZK 40:47, EZK 43:13, EZK 43:13, EZK 43:18, EZK 43:22, EZK 43:26, EZK 43:27, EZK 45:19, EZK 47:1, JOL 1:13, JOL 2:17, AMO 9:1, ZEC 9:15, ZEC 14:20, MAL 1:7, MAL 1:10, MAL 2:13

Hebrew שֻׁלְחָן (shulchan) MAL 1:7, MAL 1:12

Greek βωμός (bōmos) SIR 50:12, SIR 50:14, 1MA 1:59, 2MA 2:19, 2MA 13:8

Greek θυσιαστήριον (thusiastērion) MAT 5:23, MAT 5:24, MAT 23:20, MAT 23:35, LUK 11:51, 1CO 9:13, 1CO 9:13, 1CO 10:18, HEB 7:13, HEB 13:10, REV 11:1

Latin altare 2ES 10:21

Description and usage:

Different features of the altar for burnt offerings in the temple (Image generated by ChatGPT using OpenAI technology)Inside the Temple courtyard in Jerusalem there was a large, boxlike structure, made of bronze, which had a grate or grid in it. It stood outside the Holy Place. The priests kept a fire there all the time, for burning the animals that people brought to sacrifice to God. According to 2CH 4:1, this altar was made by Solomon and was 10 meters (33 feet) square and 5 meters (16.5 feet) high. The priests actually stood on top of this large altar, working at one of several fires maintained there. Access to the altar was by a large ramp (larger than the one in the illustration below).

This altar may have been constructed in steps or platforms or terraces. Such an altar, with three levels, is mentioned and described in EZK 43:13–EZK 43:17. The base would have had the dimensions given above, while the total height was 5 meters. The height of each level is not known.

Translation:

See the discussion at 4.2 Altars<REALIA:4.2> and 4.2.1 Stone altar<REALIA:4.2.1> above.